STATE OF NEW YORK
PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

CASE 25-E-0072 - Proceeding on Motion of the Commission as to the Rates, Charges, Rules and Regulations of Consolidated Edison Company of New York, Inc. for Electric Service.

CASE 25-G-0073 - Proceeding on Motion of the Commission as to the Rates, Charges, Rules and Regulations of Consolidated Edison Company of New York, Inc. for Gas Service.

UNLESS OTHERWISE STATED, THIS DOCUMENT SUMMARIZES THE COMMENTS MADE AT THE PUBLIC STATEMENT HEARING HELD ON **JULY 9, 2025 AT THE WESTCHESTER COUNTY CENTER, 198 CENTRAL AVENUE, WHITE PLAINS, NEW YORK 10606, STARTING AT 1:00 P.M.** THIS SUMMARY IS PROVIDED INSTEAD OF A VERBATIM TRANSCRIPT BECAUSE THE STENOGRAPHER CONTRACTED TO PREPARE THE TRANSCRIPT LOST THE STENOGRAPHIC EQUIPMENT USED AT THE HEARING, AND THE STENOGRAPHIC COMPANY WAS UNABLE TO OTHERWISE RETRIEVE THE TRANSCRIPT. THE SUMMARIES ARE BASED ON CONTEMPORANEOUS NOTES TAKEN BY THE ADMINISTATIVE LAW JUDGES PRESIDING AT THE PUBLIC STATEMENT HEARING.

JAMES A. COSTELLO and NICHOLAS PLANTY, Administrative Law Judges:

INTRODUCTION

ALJ Costello: As an initial matter, we want to inform everyone that we have Spanish interpreters available who will provide real time interpretation for people who want to listen and/or provide a comment today. We have headphones available at the table to my right for those who want to use the interpretation services. If you want to provide a comment, you will have to fill out a registration card available at the table with our Department of Public Service Outreach staff located on my left-

hand side. Also, when giving your statement, you will have to pause after a few sentences so the interpreter can interpret your statement for the record. I will now stop for a few moments to see if anyone wants to get a headset before I go on.

OFF THE RECORD.
The interpreter then provided the above statements in Spanish.
(NO ONE USED THE INTERPRETING SERVICES)

BACK ON THE RECORD.

My name is James Costello and with me is Nicholas Planty. We are two of three Administrative Law Judges for the Department of Public Service assigned to these rate cases and we are presiding over this public statement hearing, held on behalf of the New York State Public Service Commission, regarding the proposed changes in the electric and gas delivery rates and practices of the Consolidated Edison Company of New York.

I will begin by providing some background on these proceedings.

Con Edison filed amendments to its electric and gas tariff schedules on January 31, 2025, proposing to increase its annual electric and gas delivery revenues for the 12-month period ending December 31, 2026. As of its April 10, 2025 updated testimony, Con Edison proposes to increase its electric delivery revenues by approximately $1.6 billion (an 11.3 percent increase in total revenues or 17.9 percent increase in base delivery revenues), and its natural gas delivery revenues by approximately $349 million (a 10.5 percent increase in total revenues or 14.9 percent increase in base delivery revenues). The actual bill impacts of these proposed changes on any

particular customer class will vary based upon revenue allocation and rate design.

On or about May 30, 2025, direct testimony and exhibits responding to Con Edison's rate requests were filed by DPS Staff, City of New York, Assemblymember Christopher Burdick, Assemblymember MaryJane Shimsky, Assemblymember Dana Levenberg, Amtrak, Alliance for a Green Economy, Consumer Power Advocates, Environmental Defense Fund (EDF filed corrected testimony and exhibits on June 16, 2025), Electrify America LLC, Metropolitan Transportation Authority (MTA), Natural Resources Defense Council, New York Energy Consumers Council (NYECC), New York Power Authority (NYPA), Public Utility Law Project of New York, State Senator Robert Jackson, the County of Westchester, the Westchester Municipal Consortium, and the Utility Intervention Unit (UIU). UIU provided corrected testimony on June 13, 2025.

On or about June 24, 2025, rebuttal testimony was filed by Con Edison, DPS Staff, NYPA, MTA, City of New York, Assemblymember Burdick, NYECC, UIU, and individuals Roger Caiazza, Richard Ellenbogen, Constantine Kontagiannis, and Francis Menton, collectively.

By letter dated June 24, 2025, Con Edison filed a notice of impending settlement negotiations. If settlement negotiations are successful, the parties to the settlement would file a Joint Proposal to the Commission. There would then be further briefing, public comment, and an evidentiary hearing before the case is submitted to the Commission for decision. The Commission can adopt the Joint Proposal, modify the Joint Proposal, or reject the Joint Proposal.

If settlement negotiations are not successful, the administrative law judges would issue a new procedural schedule for an evidentiary hearing and post-hearing briefs. The cases then may be presented to the Commission for decision or the administrative law judges may issue a Recommended Decision. If we issue a Recommended Decision, the parties would then have an opportunity to brief their positions on those recommendations, and then the cases would be decided by the Commission.

Under New York State law, the Public Service Commission must consider the utility's proposals and may adopt or reject them in whole or in part or modify it.

At this time, the Commission must decide these cases by December 30, 2025. However, that date may be subject to further extension.

Regardless of how these cases proceed, the Public Service Commission will make the final decision regarding the Company's terms and conditions for providing electric and gas service. This hearing is being held so you can provide your comments on Con Edison's proposals for the Commission's consideration.

In making its decision, the Commission will consider the evidentiary record in these cases and the comments made at this and other public statement hearings.

The Public Service Commission has seven members -- the Chairperson, Rory Christian, and six Commissioners - James Alesi, David Valesky, John Maggiore, Uchenna Bright, Denise Sheehan, and Radina Valova.

The purpose of today's hearing is to provide you with an opportunity to share your opinions on the Company's rate filings with the Commission. The topic of today's event is limited to these particular rate cases – this is not the proper forum to raise issues that are unrelated to the Company's rate case filings. To address specific issues about your comments and account, Con Edison has materials that provide a dedicated phone number and email for customers to get assistance related to specific customer service and billing inquiries; that information is on the table that is set up outside, in the hallway.

The statements you make today will become part of the record. The court reporter here will prepare a transcript of the hearing, which will be included in the record of these proceedings, so that your comments can be considered by all members of the Commission. When it is ready, the transcript also will be available for public view on the Department of Public Service website.

Today's hearing is not a question-and-answer session; we are here only to listen to your comments.

If you do not wish to speak at today's hearing but you would like your views included in the record, there are other ways to comment. You can submit comments on the Department's website, by regular mail, or by phone. Information regarding these alternative methods is available from the Department's Office of Consumer Services staff, who are seated at the table near the door.

Regardless of how comments are submitted, they will be given equal consideration by the Commission. According to the Secretary's notice for this event, comments must be received by **November 21, 2025,** to ensure the Commission is able to consider them prior to the final decision.

If you would like to make a statement here today and you have not done so already, please fill out a registration card. The registration cards are available at the table with our Outreach staff. I will call speakers up one by one using the cards in the order in which they were received.

Please speak slowly and clearly so that the court reporter can accurately capture your statement for the record.

To the extent you wish to read a lengthy written statement, we ask that you provide an oral summary or overview here today and then submit the full statement in writing by email or mail.

Please be respectful when delivering your comments. This event is an official government proceeding, and an appropriate level of decorum is expected of everyone. Shouting, swearing, interrupting speakers, and other disruptions to the hearing are not only discourteous but also ultimately impede our ability to make sure we hear from everyone who has taken the time to be here today. Finally, we ask that you please silence your cell phones.

With that, we will turn to our first speaker.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

Anthony Merante

I am a Councilman for the 6th District, Yonkers, representing approximately 30,000 residents. I ask the Public Service Commission (PSC) to serve the public and believe that the PSC is biased towards utilities. Con Edison is raising our delivery charges by a net of 18%. I am a CPA by trade and the math for the delivery charges is incalculable. I appreciate Con Edison's honesty as to the return on equity - you should be happy if you're a shareholder. The closing of Indian Point has pushed energy prices sky high. I want to prevent battery storage, which are ticking time bombs all over, as opposed to the one controlled environment of Indian Point. The proposed increases are a trigger for inflation and will have a domino effect. I am here to protect senior citizens living on fixed incomes and forced to choose between paying for medicine, food, and energy bills. I ask the PSC to do their job and represent the public. There should be no increase. Otherwise, everyone will move out of New York State.

Kenneth Jenkins[1]

"Good afternoon, and thank you to the Public Service Commission for holding this hearing and allowing me to speak today. I am Ken Jenkins, County Executive for Westchester County, and I'm here on behalf of more than 1 million residents and thousands of businesses here in our County. I am here to today because of Con Ed - the proposed Con Ed increases are unfair, unaffordable,

[1] Taken verbatim from Official Westchester Government Videos, www.youtube.com/@officialwestchestergovvide4703.

and unacceptable for Westchester's working families, seniors, and small businesses. That's why I signed legislation unanimously passed by our County Board of Legislature in a bipartisan way, formally opposing this rate hike and making Westchester County an official party to the case.
Families are already being stretched to the breaking point. Utility bills are skyrocketing while wages remain flat. We are hearing from seniors on fixed incomes, families juggling multiple jobs, business owners barely able to stay afloat. A rate hike of this magnitude will force many to close and choose between paying their utility bills and affording necessities like food, medicine, and childcare.

"Let us be clear - investing in infrastructure and clean energy is important and we support a reliable grid and a sustainable future. But that future has to be affordable. Con Edison cannot be allowed to continue to pass their costs on to consumers without full transparency, real justification, and measurable accountability. There's been a lack of clarity in how this increase would be used and how it would benefit the average consumer.

"We offered the County Center here as a location because our residents desire that opportunity and chance to speak directly face-to-face about how this will impact their lives, and today we are happy to be here in White Plains, and yesterday you were up in Cortlandt Manor, so thank you. This is a fight for fairness. Westchester County will continue to stand up, speak out, and push back on the rate hike with everything we have, and we urge the Public Service Commission to reject this proposal in its entirety and stand with our New Yorkers and not just with the utilities.

"Thank you again for your time, attention, and service. Thank you."

Senator Shelley Mayer[2]

"As the State Senator for the 37th Senate District in Westchester, I represent cities from Yonkers to White Plains, towns from Eastchester to Harrison, and villages from Larchmont to Port Chester. The vast majority of my over 300,000 constituents are dependent on Con Edison for their utilities, and I speak on their behalf.

"First, thank you for honoring our request, and the request of County Executive Jenkins, for in-person hearings in Westchester, here in White Plains and yesterday in Cortlandt Manor. While the virtual hearings are important, it is vital to have this in-person option to hear directly from many of the Con Edison customers in Westchester County.

"I will not mince words – I am strongly opposed to Con Edison's proposal to increase its rates over the next three years, and urge that you reject them in full. This proposal, according to their own projections, would increase delivery revenues for electricity by 18% - an unacceptably large percentage at any time, but particularly while the cost of living is, frankly, unaffordable to thousands of Westchester residents. The requested increase in electric delivery revenues would mean an

[2] Taken verbatim (emphases omitted) from Senator Mayer's letter dated July 9, 2025 addressed to the Secretary to the Public Service Commission, posted on https://www.nysenate.gov/newsroom/press-releases/2025/shelley-b-mayer/state-senator-shelley-b-mayers-testimony-psc.

average residential monthly delivery bill increase of $26.60 (a 19.1% increase), while the requested increase in gas delivery revenues would mean a total monthly gas bill increase of about $46.42 (a 25.1% increase) for the typical residential customer. I urge you to reject the increases.

"Let me make a few points: First, unaffordability. The newly proposed increases are simply unaffordable for lower and middle class New Yorkers. In my district, 20% make under $100,000. Almost 20% are seniors, many living on fixed incomes. Middle to upper middle income constituents are also increasingly being pushed to the limit and face a crisis of affordability that you cannot ignore.

"This past winter, constituent after constituent called, emailed, and visited my office for help with literally unaffordable bills, driven entirely by high delivery charges approved by the PSC. While in 2022, unregulated supply costs drove high utility bills, now it is the regulated delivery charges, which are within you power to control. My constituents currently do everything possible to reduce their energy usage to lower their bills, including living on one floor rather than two; setting their thermostat too low for comfort; leaving their home cold when they're away, all to try to save funds – but to no avail. Because their delivery charges are two or three times as high as the supply costs and there is nothing they can do to change that.

"A rate increase of the magnitude sought by Con Edison will have a devastating impact on my constituents' ability to make ends meet, and could thrust them into utility debt for what might be the first time of their lives. According to the Public Utility

Law Project, almost half a million Con Edison customers are 60 days or more behind on their bills, or are cutting other essentials simply to pay for gas and electricity. We are already in crisis.

"Second, Con Edison has provided stockholders with a record 51 consecutive annual dividend increases; the longest period of consecutive annual dividend increases of any utility in the S&P 500 index. The company credits their continued emphasis 'on providing a return to [their] investors.' While Con Edison of New York is just one subsidiary of Con Edison, it is clear that their shareholders have been the beneficiaries of tremendous financial gains over the last several years. Given the dire situation faced by many Con Edison ratepayers and the fact that Con Edison is a regulated utility that has a monopoly in our service area, I believe it is the obligation of the PSC under the law to place the concerns of ratepayers over excessive returns to shareholders.

"Third, I have made no secret of my opposition to the process by which these rates are set. I take particular issue with Con Edison's proposed increase in its own profits through a "return on equity" enhancement. Judging from Con Edison's financial statements as well as executive pay, their profits are already high enough. The company is asking for a 10.1% return on equity, more than any New York utility has received in 30 years, and significantly higher than the already too high 8.8% return on equity approved in 2020, and the 9.25% return on equity approved in 2023.

"I am the sponsor of legislation, which passed the Senate again this year, to revamp the return on equity calculation and to

significantly limit the ability of utilities to obtain excessive profits at the expense of ratepayers, but until it becomes law we can only implore you to revisit the current methodology. I'm not alone in pushing for a change – others are making the same arguments, which must be considered. My other bills, all of which passed the Senate on a bipartisan basis, limit the ability of utility companies to retain revenues derived from their actual return on equity in excess of authorized rates; limit the ability of utilities to retroactively recover revenues when rate cases exceed the statutory period; and limit recovery of utility management employee salaries and other costs from inclusion in the authorized rates. I think it is very apparent that many members of the Legislature are determined to change the entire process of rate setting to prioritize ratepayers over utility profits and secret negotiations. Know that we will not stop seeking legislative reform – and I for one, am determined to achieve it next year – but in the interim, PSC for once must act on behalf of the people serviced by Con Edison and reject these increases.

"In that vein, I urge you to take these legislative proposals to heart and carefully scrutinize the operating expenses Con Edison seeks to recover, including salaries for utility management employees and expenses related to Con Edison's participation in this rate case. Additionally, I call upon the PSC to reject any efforts to include a "deadband" or "earnings sharing mechanism" which would allow Con Edison to retain earnings in excess of their approved ROE in a settlement agreement. Instead, all excess earnings above the ROE should be returned directly to ratepayers, providing needed relief to overburdened consumers.

"Lastly, with so many of my constituents under financial strain, and with the increased uncertainty and challenges brought about by the new federal legislation, which is predicted to raise energy costs for families and businesses, I call on the PSC to do more to protect constituents threatened with service termination and to require Con Edison to provide increased flexibility and affordability options with regard to payment plans and proposed service terminations. These plans should expressly include middle class ratepayers, as well as low income ratepayers, acknowledging that the utility burden is real for almost everyone dependent on Con Edison.

"In sum, I call once again on the Public Service Commission to (1) reject any rate increase, (2) scrutinize all operating costs, especially utility management salaries and other costs, to protect ratepayers, (3) reject any proposal for a deadband or earnings sharing mechanism in settlement negotiations which unfairly result in utility companies keeping excessive profits, and (4) stick resolutely and far more proactively to you legal mandate to protect all New Yorkers.

"Thank you for the opportunity to provide comments on this important matter."

Assemblymember Chris Burdick

I represent the 93rd Assembly District and thank your honors, the Department of Public Service, and the Public Service Commission for the public outreach and more robust opportunity to comment on Con Edison's requested rate increases. Con Edison's request is aggressive, avaricious, and has stirred up a hornets' nest. You will see unprecedented advocacy and tremendous public outcry

in opposition. I became an intervenor in this case because I felt an obligation to my constituents to do everything I can to oppose Con Edison's request and to get under hood so that I am better equipped to see the process to change it.

In contrast to the requested 11.4% increase in electric rates and 13.2% increase in gas rates, Social Security has increased only 2.5%. So many seniors already are reeling from the existing utility rates. I concur with what has been said by the speakers before me. I also point out a survey conducted by Assemblymember Dana Levenberg that included dispassionate questions to which respondents indicated concern and frustration with rising delivery costs that they are unable to control or budget for. People are already reeling with the existing rates. How much is enough? The proposed rate increases are astronomical, are causing many to consider moving out of New York, and are particularly impacting seniors on fixed incomes.

Con Edison already has significant arrears. As of December 2024, over 496,000 residential are over 60 days behind on their bills, with arrears totaling $1.4 billion. This problem will only get worse if the Public Service Commission approves the requested rate increases. The Public Service Commission has a statutory obligation to balance safety, reliability, and reasonable rates. I concur with Governor Hochul back in February and request that Con Edison's request be rejected and that Con Edison go back to drawing board and find a better way. There should be no ROE above 8%, no equity ratio greater than 47%, and settlements for wrongdoing should not be allowed to be passed on as a burden on ratepayers. I respectfully urge the Public Service Commission to reject Con Edison's requested rate increase.

David Imamura

I am on the Westchester County Board of Legislators and represent District 12. Con Edison's proposed increases are unconscionable. People are already facing such high prices and now Con Edison requests double digit increases. Our residents should not be forced to choose between paying their mortgages, buying food, or paying energy bills. It is not right to ask our residents to subsidize Con Edison's shareholders and executives. We need action here and now. Our residents are not benefitting from proposed infrastructure investments, the majority of which are proposed for New York City, and should not have to bear the costs of investments that only will benefit others.

David Tubiolo

I am on the Westchester County Board of Legislators and represent District 14. My biggest concern is the everyday working person and retired seniors who have worked hard their whole lives. People already can barely afford food and utilities, and things continue to become more expensive. People are leaving New York because of unaffordability. We need your help to keep things affordable. Help us control the rates, help working people, help seniors (AARP is here), help everyday people.

Barbara DiGiacinto

I am a member of the North Castle Town Board but am speaking here as a resident. I want to thank the Judges and Senator Mayer. People of Westchester are terrified at the thought of electric increases. We request the Public Service Commission to reject the requested raises and not burden households with any

further increases. Con Edison's CEO and stockholders need to demonstrate that they are taking on the burden instead of passing it on to customers. Con Edison stock recently increased 12% per share. The PSC has approved electric rate increases of 5.1% in August 2023, 4.2% in January 2024, and 1.4% in January 2025 – a total of 14.7% over 16 months. The gas rate increases increased a total of 21.7% over 16 months. The increases are unacceptable and unconscionable. Lowering my usage does not lower my bills – the electric and gas delivery rates are more than double the supply costs. The proposed increases are a death knell for small businesses and mom and pop stores that are still recovering from the loss of sales due to the COVID pandemic. The increases are killing our seniors and people living paycheck by paycheck. Households with double incomes are struggling and many residents are already doing without. The increases have become intolerable.

Josh Nathan

I am a member of the Rye City Council. The rate setting process provides little accountability and needs an overhaul. The size of the proposed rate hike is extraordinary and shows that Con Edison has a tin ear when it comes to the cost of living, the effects on seniors, and the cuts to benefits. Customers have no choice but to take service from this monopoly. Con Edison's proposal is outrageous, embarrassing, terrible, and destructive. The Public Service Commission is supposed to provide a check on utilities, not a rubber stamp. I urge the Public Service Commission to reject Con Edison's proposal, and ask that Senator Mayer please fix the system. Residents need help.

Gregory Totino

I am the Communications Director for State Senator Andrea Stewart-Cousins (35th Senate District) and am appearing on her behalf. I want to read into the record a March 5, 2025 letter from Senator Stewart-Cousins to Public Service Commission Chair Rory M. Christian.[3]

"As the State Senator of the 35th Senate District which includes most of the City of Yonkers, the Town of Greenburgh and the Town of Mount Pleasant in Westchester County, I write to strongly oppose the rate increases requested by Consolidated Edison. My constituents are already faced with outlandish electric and gas bills because of the previous increases the PSC has granted to the company.

"ConEd's request flies in the face of the priorities of the State Senate, Assembly and the Governor to make life for New Yorkers more affordable. I urge you to deny this request.

"This past January, the most recent increase was put into effect, creating extreme hardship for many of my constituents. This was the latest increase which the PSC has granted Con Ed on a yearly basis for at least the past 6 years. It is time to change the game. ConEd's delivery rates are too high now; to increase them further increases the burden on the public.

"The company's rationale for the rate increase has been the same every year. And every year they are successful. They need more

[3] The body of Senator Stewart-Cousins' letter dated March 5, 2025 is reproduced verbatim in the text.

money to replace infrastructure and distribution lines, to build more underground lines, and to enhance customer service. Nowhere in their rationale is how these improvements will lead to lowering the cost of energy. Improvements and maintenance should not be made on the shoulders of their customers.

"I have seen bills from my constituents where ConEd's delivery costs are twice as much as their supply costs. This is unfair and should be reviewed. Their request for an 11.4% increase for electricity and a 13.3% increase in gas places an extra burden on people who are already in sticker shock with their current bills.

"I am aware that ConEd has asked for this one year increase with the hope that they will negotiate with the PSC for three year increases at a lower rate. It is a game, and either way, it's the customers who feel the impact.

"On behalf of the residents and businesses in my district, I urge the Public Service Commission to listen to the public and to deny ConEd's request to increase its already excessive energy rates."

Robert Kahn

I am the President of the Highlands White Plains Civic Association, which has approximately 14,000 members, and am speaking here as a resident. Based on the requested increases, it sounds like Con Ed put off major upgrades until an expensive solution was needed. I am guessing that it will take between five to ten years to upgrade all of White Plains, but Con Ed is trying to finance that with these giant rate hikes. Please make

them recalculate how long they will need for the upgrades and stop making me pay for new infrastructure that I'm unlikely to see. Adjust the rates downward.

Alexandra Marshall

I am the Manager of the Village of Scarsdale, which has approximately 18,000 residents. The Village of Scarsdale has joined as a party to these rate cases as part of the Westchester Municipal Consortium. The residents are shocked at the proposed bill increases, which are unsustainable for seniors, those on fixed incomes, and young families. Our Mayor, Justin K. Arest, submitted a letter to the Chair of the Public Service Commission, which expressed deep frustration over the continued failure of the PSC to safeguard ratepayers from Con Edison's excessive and unjustified rate increases and urged Governor Hochul and the PSC to reject any further increases and take decisive action to prevent unchecked rate hikes that place an undue burden on New Yorkers. The proposed increases are not sustainable.

Robert Koerner

Thank you for being here. I am a retired utility worker for Con Edison. Eventually, Con Edison will get an increase, but what is the return for the ratepayers? Who can I get in touch with to discuss this? (Judge Costello directed him to the Office of Consumer Services' Staff present at the hearing).

Thomas Roach

I am the Mayor of the City of White Plains. Out of 41 municipalities, 40 have become parties to the rate proceedings as part of the Westchester Municipal Consortium. The proposed

rate increase for energy delivery is very high. I recognize that Con Edison is a public corporation, but small businesses will eat into their profits to satisfy customers, and Con Edison should do so as well. People are already on the edge financially and cannot shop around for better prices for energy delivery.

Alan Zaretsky

I am a landlord speaking on my own behalf and want to thank all the elected officials for being on the same side. I don't know of any businesses, no matter what they do, that have bad management and are rewarded with increases. Con Edison is inept. You cannot speak to anyone about incorrect or wrong billing. I contacted the PSC and they told me to settle with Con Ed first, which is impossible to do.

I was forced to convert from oil to gas and did not receive a bill from Con Ed. I contacted Con Ed - this is all documented - and four years later Con Ed sent me a bill for $1.4 million and a shutoff notice. It took 18 months to resolve the issue. I requested how they calculated the amount and finally settled the issue for $500,000, but I want them to admit responsibility in writing. All during that time, I kept getting turnoff notices and had to wait on the phone for hours at a time. The day after we got the cancellation notice, Con Ed sent notices to our tenants stating that the landlord wasn't paying the energy bills. The PSC was helpful and said that, if it was Con Ed's billing mistake, it could only go back 18 months on billing.

Bullying and threatening other companies is bad business. Do not reward bad management – it will only encourage bad business

and make it worse because Con Ed knows it will get paid anyway. I'd be out of business or in jail if I ran my business that way. Landlords have to report income to municipalities, and I have trouble reporting the numbers because Con Ed cannot read its own meters and rebills multiple times.

Joseph Phillips

I am a White Plains resident and would like to thank Senator Mayer. I only recently learned about Con Edison's dividend increases, and I'm astounded. Con Edison is asking service customers to pay more to maintain its profit margin. Con Edison just wants to increase profitability. I oppose the rate increases. Individuals and families are struggling and many customers are forced to make tough decisions. Con Edison should be held accountable. Instead of burdening customers, Con Edison should remove waste and increase efficiency. I urge the Public Service Commission to reject Con Edison's request.

Theresa Flora

I am a resident of Mount Kisco and the Deputy Mayor. I am speaking on behalf of the residents of Mount Kisko, which includes many people with low incomes, on fixed incomes, seniors, and small businesses. These people are already struggling with the increases, and Con Edison's new proposal should be rejected out of the gate. The proposed increases are so egregious. Energy bills are three times more than what they used to be, and our residents cannot be any more conservative or energy efficient. It is abusive. Con Edison is preying on those struggling customers. I would like to thank Senator Mayer and request that the Public Service Commission please reject this rate hike.

Elaine Weir

I have been a resident of Westchester County for over 30 years and oppose the proposed rate increases. Although we have switched to geothermal and have saved on our energy bills, our bills have soared this year. I am asking the Public Service Commission – please do not approve these rate increases. There are other ways for Con Edison to meet its budget goals – decrease the dividends. Perhaps add a performance metric. The Public Service Commission should promote the public good, not increase the wealth of the few. This is like a reverse Robin Hood - taking from working class to enrich the top earners. Thank you, Senator Mayer.

Karen Schleimer

I am a resident of Mount Kisko and on the Village Board of Trustees and was asked to speak today. I want to second the statements by Senator Mayer, Assemblymember Burdick, Supervisor Ken Jenkins, and the elected official for North Castle. No one gets increases like this. Other increases, like COLA and wages, are between two to three percent. The requested increases here are out of control. Con Edison is an authorized monopoly. People have no place to go except Con Edison. It's the Public Service Commission's responsibility to make sure what's being done is reasonable and rational. Putting the increases on the backs of ratepayers is unacceptable. I join the other speakers in rejecting the proposed rate increases.

Ellen Calves

I am the Supervisor of the Town of Bedford, which is part of the Westchester Consortium. A small portion of the Town is served

by Con Edison and others are in NYSEG's service territory. The complexity and lack of transparency of the process is eye opening. It feels like the Public Service Commission leaves the outcome to the settlement process. Westchester doesn't always have the voice it deserves in the settlement process. Con Edison is requesting untenable increases far outpacing inflation. Many of the planned upgrades are going to New York City and are not benefitting Westchester. I hope our comments are not falling on deaf ears and that the Public Service Commission takes the comments to heart. We do not need and cannot take this type of increase. Con Edison's rates should be segregated, and we should pay for improvements for Westchester, not New York City. We have above-ground lines, which are less reliable and less expensive, and we shouldn't have to support New York City.

Gregory Spock

Thank you, Judges. My wife and I purchased a home around five years ago, and we replaced gas with heat pumps, and despite that work our energy bills continue to increase. Con Edison sinks money into fossil fuel gas lines that are past their useful life over which they have a monopoly, although they say they prioritize clean energy. I ask that Con Edison invest in electrification and geothermal and urge waiting for the IRA repeal dust to settle.

Karen Kaffer

I am speaking on behalf of AARP, many members of which have moderate, low, or fixed incomes. The economy is still recovering from the impact of the COVID pandemic, and record high utility bills already are hurting New Yorkers financially.

Con Edison has 377,000 households behind on their utility bills more than 60 days already. Is this really the time to raise typical electric rates $27 a month and to raise typical gas rates? Rapidly rising utility bills are not sustainable. People are struggling to cope with unaffordability.

Charlotte Watson

I am a resident of New Castle. We need the Public Service Commission to represent us. We are trying to survive. I attended a public hearing held by Senator Mayer and heard seniors talking about having to lower their heat, covering up and shivering, reducing their food purchases and transportation costs, and stretching their medications to get by. I live in less than 1,300 square feet, and it costs almost $1,300 to heat in the winter, with $800 of that in delivery charges. Apartments are not conducive to solar or geothermal energy. We cannot afford to live, unlike Con Edison executives. I echo the public officials who spoke today. The Public Service Commission should reject the increases, investigate Con Edison, and lower the rates. Medicaid is being cut, and raising rates will contribute to deaths. Con Edison is a monopoly and takes full advantage of that. I worked in a nonprofit and for the State for 39 years. We need Con Edison to be public servants. Please reject the rate request, and look into the delivery charge. We are depending on the Judges and the Public Service Commission. We need your help to protect the State of New York.

Howie Ravikoff

I am a member of the Landlord Council. Senator Mayer nailed it, and we're very grateful to have her representing us. Con Edison has a troubling pattern of mismanagement. Rising costs,

infrastructure needs, and climate change are not new. Because of Con Edison's inadequate long-term planning, it now seeks double digit increases, and its customers are left with the consequences. There is a lack of true oversight. We need our government to step up. We need performance-based accountability and protection. The people and businesses of Westchester County deserve better. This is not just a call for a rejection of the proposed increases but for systematic overhaul.

Alana Ciuffetelli

Good afternoon. I'm a resident and Con Edison's proposal is unacceptable, unaffordable, and directly hits our already strained budgets. The cost of everything is up – margins vanishing, and now Con Edison wants more. It is forcing me into impossible decisions to not repair and maintain my buildings, but it's not just about landlords, it's about housing stock. The Public Service Commission is here to represent the public interest and not merely rubber stamp Con Edison's requested increases. If affordability really matters, now is the time to act and reject Con Edison's requests. Do not betray the people you're charged to protect.

Brenda Sutherland

I was not planning on speaking but felt obligated to speak for myself and my neighbors. I am a retired teacher, senior citizen, and resident of Tarrytown. I live in a humble, working-class neighborhood. I was considering moving because of Con Edison, but now I have grandchildren here and will have to change my lifestyle to stay. Our bills are outrageous. For just gas, I pay around $180 in usage and around $500 for delivery costs. Our houses are just feet apart, so those

delivery costs just don't make sense. The costs are very hard on myself and my neighbors. Con Edison is advertising – airtime costs a lot, but it's all public relations, not information to educate us. PR will not change our minds. We work too hard for our money and you're pushing us out.

Anant Nambiar

I live in Larchmont. I am a Town of Mamaroneck Councilmember but am speaking here as a private citizen. The Westchester County Consortium has asked Con Edison to justify the blended increases to Westchester and New York City, when 96% of the investment is going to New York City. I have solar panels on my house. I have zero electric usage and probably contribute to the grid, but Con Edison is still charging me a $50 delivery charge. There is no way from me to appeal. Con Edison is not giving Westchester residents the benefits of solar panels and should not be able to raise the rates for Westchester the same as it does for New York City.

Steven Schwartz

Thank you for coming here to listen. I am a White Plains resident, and over the last few years my Con Edison bill has gone up astronomically. I have a small house with all new windows, but my monthly bill is still $1,300. Apparently, Con Edison asks for very high increases and gets increases reduced a little – it really is unfair. We need gas and electricity and have no choice. It is out of control.

Michael Pineda

My fight is personal. I am helping with utility bills for my aging parents. Even though we are more energy efficient, the

utility bills keep going up and up. How are the increases even defensible? We need more protection and responsibility from the PSC.

Jeff Gitlin

I live in White Plains and am on the board of co-op building. We just refinanced and still have a mortgage on an old 1950's building. We try to keep the maintenance fee increases between 2-3%. Real estate taxes and insurance have gone up. If the electric bill goes up, it gets passed on. If Con Ed's rates increase it could negatively affect people in our building.

CONCLUSION

ALJ Costello: Again, you may submit comments regarding these proceedings by the other means described earlier, even if you spoke today. You must do so by **November 21, 2025**, for those comments to be considered.

Also, we will be holding another public statement hearing at this location starting at 6 p.m. In addition, tomorrow, July 10th, there are hearings at 1 p.m. and 6 p.m. at the C.W. Mixon Center, in Queens, New York, at 112-50 Springfield Boulevard. And tomorrow, July 10th, also at 1 p.m. and 6 p.m., we'll have hearings at the Residence Inn, Marriott, at 1776 Eastchester Road, in the Bronx. Later in the month, on July 22nd and July 23rd at 6 p.m., we will be holding hearings at the Jewish Community Center of Staten Island, at 1466 Manor Road.

Thank you all for your participation today. This hearing is now concluded.